

Relationship Intelligence Master Guidebook

Differences Between Men and Women in Relationships

This guidebook is a working sourcebook for the Relationship Intelligence app. It is not a transcript archive, a clinical manual, or a diagnosis tool. It uses the videos and app cards as interpretive source material, then cross-checks the strongest claims against relationship science, mate-preference research, personality research, and sexual-outcome research.

The central premise is simple: men and women are not interchangeable in dating and relationships, but they are also not cartoons. Average sex differences can matter in courtship, sex, safety, status, contribution, resentment, family formation, and conflict repair. Individual variation is still large, so the app should use these patterns as hypotheses to test against behavior, not as verdicts.

Source Bedrock

Videos and app-source material used:

- Modern Wisdom / Louise Perry: "The Real Effects Of No Strings Attached" (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1_t4FtpR58w)
- Modern Wisdom / Alison Armstrong: "How to Treat Men Better" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4hibdmZk0IE>)
- Modern Wisdom / Suzanne Venker: "Women Work So Hard For Lives They Don't Want" (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u_CBFa4BXq4)
- Modern Wisdom / Dr. Tracy Vaillancourt: "The Secret Games Women Play" (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dZCLZ_w1BUK)
- Modern Wisdom / Dr. Dani Sulikowski: "The Worst Things Women Do To Each Other" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsy41uI1dmY>)
- Orion Taraban: "What Women Really Want" (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4ZUk_6pLqek)
- Orion Taraban: "What women want: the answer to the question" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SfpqDaZnvYk>)
- Orion Taraban: "How women win: happy hunting" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=usC-PHjTIIY>)
- Orion Taraban: "Don't be her option: why you get left on read" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UzKXL5-w08A>)
- Kait Willett: "The Only Thing Women Want From Men" (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SQ9j_lwDrLsI)
- Relationship Intelligence app cards from coach-database.js, especially: early calm bid, early date conduct, feminine standards, Orion happy hunting, Orion fisherman/hunter, Orion do-not-chase, Kait stated-versus-revealed preferences, Kait capacity/status, Alison usefulness/appreciation, Vaillancourt sexy-peer/indirect aggression, Dani female intrasexual competition, Louise Perry info-diet/sexual-market cards, contribution/reciprocity, sex pacing, social rivalry, public respect, digital loyalty, behavior change, repair, and life grounding.

Chapter 1: The Core Map

The app should teach users to separate five questions that often get fused together:

1. Is there attraction?
2. Is there safety?
3. Is there respect?
4. Is there reciprocal contribution?
5. Is there a shared life path?

Modern dating often treats these as one question: "Do they like me?" That is too thin. Someone can like you and still be unsafe. Someone can be safe and still not inspire desire. Someone can desire you and still not respect you. Someone can respect you and still not want your life. Someone can say all the right words and still not contribute when the relationship asks for ordinary sacrifice.

The app's coach should therefore avoid one-size-fits-all advice. It should ask what kind of problem the user is facing: early attraction, selection, reciprocity, digital loyalty, social rivalry, sex pacing, public respect, information diet, repair, or long-term role design.

Example Story

Evan is dating Claire. She replies warmly when he entertains her, compliments her, and plans the date. But she does not help make plans easier, ask about his responsibilities, or show care for his time. Evan asks, "Does she like me?" The better question is: "Does her interest translate into reciprocal participation?" If he keeps escalating attention while receiving only passive enjoyment, he may train the relationship into one-way consumption.

App Rule

Do not ask only, "Is this person attracted?" Ask, "What behavior is this dynamic rewarding?"

Chapter 2: What Women Say They Want vs. What They Respond To

A recurring claim from Orion and Kait is that stated preferences are not the same as revealed attraction. Women may sincerely say they want kindness, safety, loyalty, and emotional availability. Those traits matter. But in live romantic choice, they often matter most when they are attached to a man who already registers as attractive, competent, directed, socially legible, and self-respecting.

This should not be reduced to "women lie." A better interpretation is:

- People are often poor reporters of what produces attraction in real time.
- Stated ideals are usually moral and conscious.
- Attraction is embodied, comparative, status-sensitive, and context-sensitive.
- Long-term satisfaction still requires kindness, reliability, responsiveness, and repair.

The correction is not for men to become cruel or manipulative. The correction is for men to stop offering only niceness, attention, and emotional availability while hiding their direction, standards, capability, and life structure.

Clinical / Research Support

Mate-preference work across cultures finds both overlap and sex differences. Buss's 37-culture study found that both men and women value kindness and intelligence, while women more often weight resource/status cues and men more often weight physical attractiveness cues in long-term mate selection. Later replication across 45 countries preserved many of these broad patterns while also showing cultural variability.

Kait's app-relevant point maps onto a broader research problem: ideal-partner preference lists do not always predict actual partner choice as strongly as people assume. The coach should therefore ask for behavior: pursuit, relaxation, sexual interest, respect, follow-through, and willingness to enter the other person's life.

Example Story

Marcus says, "I'm kind, loyal, and emotionally available. Why don't women want that?" The coach should not answer, "Women dislike kindness." The better answer is: "Those traits are necessary but not sufficient. Are they attached to visible self-command? Does your life have direction? Do you handle uncertainty calmly? Do you make clean invitations? Do you let reciprocal effort matter?"

App Cards

- kait-revealed-preference-gap
- kait-capacity-status-signal
- orion-what-women-want-social-comparison
- early-calm-bid
- early-date-conduct

Chapter 3: What Men Need But Often Do Not Say Cleanly

The Alison Armstrong layer is useful because it names a male pain point that can otherwise sound petty: men often need to feel respected, useful, trusted, appreciated, and not treated as defective women. The app should not teach women to flatter men falsely. It should teach women to understand that appreciation is not decoration; it is part of how many men register that their effort matters.

Men often become resentful when:

- Their contribution is corrected before it is recognized.
- Their initiative is treated as incompetent by default.
- Their need for respect is reframed as ego.
- Their sexuality is treated as crude rather than directional and bond-forming.
- Their attempts to solve problems are mocked instead of translated.
- Their public status is damaged by the partner who is supposed to protect the couple.

The app should also teach men that respect cannot be demanded as tribute. It must be made easy by competent behavior, self-command, fairness, and repair.

Example Story

Anna asks Ben to fix something in the house. He does it imperfectly. Before she says thank you, she corrects three details. Ben hears, "My effort does not count unless I do it exactly her way." Anna hears, "If I praise the effort, I will be stuck managing the standard forever." The repair is not "men need praise no matter what" or "women should shut up." The repair is sequencing: appreciation first, correction later, and clearer ownership standards before the task.

App Cards

- Alison usefulness / appreciation cards
- contribution / reciprocity
- public_respect
- behavior_change
- repair

Chapter 4: Casual Sex, Sex Pacing, and the No-Strings-Attached Error

The Louise Perry video belongs in a major chapter on sexual-market incentives. Its most app-useful claim is that "no strings attached" is not equally neutral for everyone. Sexual freedom can benefit people who are unrestricted, high-agency, low-regret, well-supported, and clear about their values. But casual sex can also create asymmetrical risks: pregnancy, reputational harm, coercion ambiguity, orgasm inequality, attachment mismatch, and emotional regret.

The app should not moralize sex as dirty. It should ask: what does sex do in this relationship, at this stage, for these two people?

Key distinctions:

- Sex can intensify attention without proving commitment.
- Sexual access can create the feeling of closeness before there is shared responsibility.
- Men and women may experience different average costs in casual-sex contexts.
- Some people thrive in unrestricted sexual cultures; others suffer while pretending to be liberated.
- A relationship app should help users identify their real values rather than adopt the market's default script.

Clinical / Research Support

Research on casual sex is mixed and individual-difference-sensitive. Vrangalova's work suggests sociosexuality moderates whether casual sex predicts better or worse well-being. Kennair, Bendixen, and Buss report sex differences in sexual regret, with women more likely to regret casual sex and men more likely to regret missed sexual opportunities. Orgasm-gap research repeatedly finds women, especially in heterosexual casual contexts, report orgasm less often than men. These findings do not mean casual sex is always harmful; they mean "it is all the same for everyone" is empirically

weak.

Example Story

Nate and Julia have strong chemistry after three dates. Nate worries that if they have sex too soon, he may lose interest. Julia worries that if she slows down, he will leave. The coach should not answer with shame. It should say: keep attraction alive, but let ordinary behavior prove whether more access deepens the bond. Before escalating, test respect, reciprocity, contribution, and values.

App Cards

- sex_pacing
- Orion sex pacing / contribution cards
- Louise Perry / sexual-market cards
- early-pacing-too-fast

Chapter 5: Women as Hunters, Men as Fishermen

Orion's "happy hunting" and "fisherman/hunter" model is useful when softened and made ethical. Men often benefit from creating broad opportunity: build a visible life, make clean invitations, and choose from women who choose back. Women can often benefit from selecting more intentionally rather than letting random male attention decide their dating life.

For women, "hunting" does not mean chasing men or surrendering standards. It means:

- Know why this specific man interests you before accepting the date.
- Let attraction and respect both matter.
- Show up as a conditional yes: warm if things go well, free to slow down or say no.
- Test character, direction, safety, attraction, and long-term fit.
- Do not use sex, cool-girl availability, or passive attention as commitment shortcuts.

For men, "fishing" does not mean doing nothing. It means:

- Build a life worth entering.
- Make your direction visible.
- Invite clearly.
- Stop trying to convert indifference into devotion.
- Let reciprocal effort affect access.

Example Story

Maya says yes to dates because men ask and she does not want to seem rude. She ends up with men she never selected. The coach should move her from passive screening to intentional selection: "What are three reasons this man is worth learning about? What life is he building? Would you respect becoming closer to that life?"

App Cards

- orion-happy-hunting-women
- orion-fishermen-hunters-men
- dating_strategy
- early-feminine-standards

Chapter 6: Contribution, Reciprocity, and the Relationship Opportunity

A major app insight is that attraction is not only chemistry. It is also the perception of a real relationship opportunity. People become more attractive when their lives provide a dignified role for the other person.

For men asking about women, this often means: do not only provide dates, attention, and sex. Create a path for her to participate in your life. Ask for small, appropriate contribution: help choose a plan, bring something, care for a shared problem, remember something that matters, support a real responsibility. Then appreciate it. This is not servitude; it is evidence that she can enter the economy of your life.

For women asking about men, reciprocity means not rewarding vague pursuit while ignoring character. Does he plan? Does he follow through? Does he protect your pace? Does he become more honorable around desire? Does his interest include responsibility?

Example Story

Caleb always picks the restaurant, drives, pays, entertains, and reassures. He never asks for anything. Later he resents that Sophia "doesn't care for him." But he built a dynamic where her only role was receiving. The coach should advise one small dignified ask: "I will handle the plan; help me choose between these two options." Then watch whether participation makes her warmer or resentful.

App Cards

- contribution / reciprocity
- Orion incentive audit
- Alison usefulness / appreciation
- Kait capacity/status

Chapter 7: Female Intrasexual Competition and Social Rivalry

Vaillancourt and Dani Sulikowski belong in the guidebook because many users, especially women, may not understand that social pressure from other women can be protective, competitive, anxious, ideological, or status-leveling. The app should not teach paranoia. It should teach discrimination.

Female intrasexual competition often operates indirectly because direct aggression is costly and social belonging matters. The pressure may appear as gossip, exclusion, mockery, reputational framing, sexual shaming, concern, eye-rolling, or advice to become smaller. A woman who becomes visibly attractive, sexually expressive, loved, chosen, competent, or family-oriented may threaten a peer group's identity or status ranking.

The user should ask:

- Is this advice specific and safety-minded?
- Does it give evidence, or does it mainly create shame?
- Does it protect my life, or keep me acceptable to the group?
- If I obey this advice for five years, do I get more love, peace, family, dignity, and better men, or only more group approval?
- Can these friends celebrate my beauty, commitment, family desire, and good relationship?

Example Story

Leah likes a serious man. Her friends say she is "acting desperate" because she dresses beautifully for him and wants commitment. One friend gives concrete safety evidence: "He cancels plans and pressures you sexually." Another only sneers: "You are becoming boring." The first friend may be protective. The second may be enforcing group norms. The app should teach Leah to separate evidence from social punishment.

App Cards

- mw-vaillancourt-sexy-peers-indirect-aggression
- Dani female intrasexual competition cards
- social_rivalry
- outside_validation

Chapter 8: Public Respect, Digital Loyalty, and Information Diet

Modern relationships are now shaped by audiences: group chats, Instagram, TikTok, DMs, podcasts, and private message threads. A couple can be weakened by third-party attention long before traditional cheating occurs.

Three app categories matter here:

Public Respect

Disagreement is allowed. Public humiliation is different. Correcting, mocking, refuting, or making a partner look foolish in front of others can damage couple status and attraction. The repair is a next-time rule: sensitive corrections happen privately or in a way that protects both people.

Digital Loyalty

The question is not only "Did cheating happen?" The question is whether private attention with outsiders leaks the relationship container. A healthy boundary is not surveillance. It is a clear standard around DMs, flirtation, secrecy, and voluntary transparency.

Information Diet

The app should treat content as behavioral training. Does repeated content make the user more grateful, truthful, kind, loyal, and responsible? Or does it train contempt, suspicion, entitlement, and gender-war reflexes?

Modern feminism's app-relevant error here is not that women should lack autonomy. It is that some online scripts define autonomy as never owing consideration, never needing men, never prioritizing family, never admiring masculine contribution, and interpreting male needs as control. The male equivalent is red-pill ideology that defines masculinity as domination, sexual leverage, contempt, and emotional withholding. Both scripts corrode love.

Example Story

Olivia consumes content telling her that any expectation from her boyfriend is control. Ryan consumes content telling him that any emotional request from Olivia is manipulation. Their information diets become invisible third partners. The coach should not debate the internet; it should ask what these inputs produce in the relationship.

App Cards

- public_respect
- digital_boundary
- outside_validation
- info_diet
- Louise Perry / Suzanne Venker / culture cards

Chapter 9: The Feminism Error, Stated Carefully

The guidebook should not caricature feminism. Some feminist corrections were necessary: women needed legal rights, protection from coercion, access to education, political voice, financial agency, and freedom from abusive dependency. The app should never romanticize oppression.

The relationship error comes from a different place: modern pop-feminist dating scripts sometimes import market individualism into intimacy. The result is:

- Autonomy without attachment.
- Equality interpreted as sameness.
- Sexual freedom interpreted as costless symmetry.
- Female empowerment interpreted as never needing, serving, admiring, or choosing a man.
- Male need for respect interpreted as patriarchal entitlement.
- Family desire framed as failure or social surrender.
- Peer approval mistaken for wisdom.
- Career/status maximization treated as the only respectable female life.

The correction is not to tell women to become subordinate. The correction is to restore tradeoffs, embodiment, difference, reciprocity, and values. A woman may want career, beauty, family, freedom, status, travel, sexual exploration, friendship, and spiritual peace. She may not be able to maximize all of them at once. A man may want sex, respect, peace, appreciation, freedom, fatherhood, competence, admiration, and loyalty. He may not be able to receive those while offering no responsibility, direction, emotional discipline, or care.

Better Frame

The question is not "Who wins?" It is "What shared life are these two people building, and what behaviors make that life more likely?"

Chapter 10: Jordan Peterson-Style Responsibility Frame

The app can use a Peterson-style frame without turning the coach into ideology:

- Tell the truth.
- Carry responsibility voluntarily.
- Notice resentment before it becomes contempt.
- Become competent enough to be useful.
- Choose a partner partly by whether you can build something difficult together.
- Do not outsource meaning to romance alone.
- Do not confuse compassion with enabling.
- Do not confuse equality with sameness.

This frame is useful because relationship problems often become abstract moral arguments when they are actually failures of responsibility, truth, and reciprocal sacrifice.

Example Story

James says his wife is ungrateful. His wife says he never owns the household. A responsibility frame asks: who owns what domain, including noticing, planning, execution, and follow-up? Gratitude cannot replace ownership; ownership cannot erase appreciation.

App Cards

- behavior_change
- repair
- contribution / reciprocity
- life reset / grounding

Chapter 11: Repair and Long-Term Bond Maintenance

The early-dating engine must not erase the long-term relationship engine. In mature relationships, desire, gratitude, sex, repair, responsibility, and admiration must be practiced on purpose. Familiarity will not automatically preserve them.

Long-term repair should ask:

- What happened?
- What did each person hear?
- What need or value was threatened?
- What behavior should change next time?
- What evidence would prove the repair worked?
- What routine makes the new behavior durable?

The app should keep therapy language only if it converts into behavior. Otherwise users get categorization without change.

Example Story

After ten years, Maria stops thanking Daniel for routine contributions. Daniel withdraws. Maria experiences him as emotionally lazy. He experiences her as entitled. The coach should not only process feelings. It should prescribe a routine: clean appreciation moments, ownership maps, and one weekly repair conversation where changes are measured by behavior.

App Cards

- repair
- behavior_change
- appreciation
- mature bond rules
- peace / respect / repair

Chapter 12: Coaching Principles for the App

The coach should follow these principles:

1. Start with the user's situation, not the expert's favorite theory.
2. Require role, target, stage, and situation type when possible.
3. Detect mismatch between the chosen category and the text.
4. Give stage-specific advice: early, committed, mature.
5. Separate attraction, safety, respect, reciprocity, and shared life.
6. Use source cards as explanatory backing, not as boilerplate.
7. Give a next move, a pitfall, a behavior to adopt, and evidence to watch.
8. Be willing to say: this is not a dating-strategy issue; this is safety, repair, or values.

9. Never use sex-difference models to excuse coercion, contempt, humiliation, surveillance, or isolation.
10. Treat modern ideology as an information diet: judge it by behavioral output.

Practical Field Guides

For a Man Dating a Woman

Ask:

- Is my life legible enough to enter?
- Am I offering only attention, sex, and entertainment?
- Have I made one clear invitation?
- Am I rewarding weak reciprocity?
- Am I asking for contribution in a dignified way?
- Does she become warmer when given a useful role?
- Does she respect my time, public dignity, and standards?

Do:

- Make clean bids.
- Stay composed.
- Show direction through behavior.
- Invite small contribution.
- Appreciate useful movement.
- Keep sexual escalation connected to respect and reciprocity.

Avoid:

- Overexplaining.
- Chasing chronic ambiguity.
- Becoming the unconditional option.
- Treating bitterness as insight.
- Calling every female hesitation manipulation.

For a Woman Dating a Man

Ask:

- Did I choose this man or just react to attention?
- Am I attracted and respectful, or only reassured?
- Does he have direction, character, safety, and follow-through?

- Does he handle my pace and no calmly?
- Are my friends giving evidence or enforcing group norms?
- Am I using sex, cool-girl performance, or passivity to secure commitment?

Do:

- Select intentionally.
- Show up warm when you are a real conditional yes.
- Keep standards visible.
- Watch behavior under desire, inconvenience, and disappointment.
- Separate social pressure from safety evidence.

Avoid:

- Lazy dating from boredom.
- Outsourcing mate choice to friends.
- Confusing anxiety with intuition.
- Treating family desire as embarrassing if it is actually your value.
- Ignoring real safety warnings because the chemistry is strong.

For Committed Couples

Ask:

- What is the repeated behavior?
- What system rewards it?
- What does each person hear?
- What would repair look like next time?
- Are we turning toward bids?
- Are roles, resources, intimacy, and responsibility explicit?

Do:

- Make behavioral requests.
- Separate appreciation from correction.
- Protect public respect.
- Build routines.
- Track whether repair changes the next similar moment.

Avoid:

- Endless processing with no behavior change.
- Therapy language as a weapon.

- Phone policing.
- Public humiliation.
- Scorekeeping as the only memory.

Evidence Appendix

The guidebook uses the following research as ballast:

- Buss, D. M. (1989). Sex differences in human mate preferences: evolutionary hypotheses tested in 37 cultures. <https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/behavioral-and-brain-sciences/article/sex-differences-in-human-mate-preferences-evolutionary-hypotheses-tested-in-37-cultures/0E112ACEB2E7BC877805E3AC11ABC889>
- Walter, K. V. et al. (2020). Sex differences in mate preferences across 45 countries: a large-scale replication. <https://research.dial.uclouvain.be/bitstreams/8ade2105-ac77-4ba7-95b3-5a6c97e925dc/download>
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- Andrejek, N. et al. (2022). Climax as work: heteronormativity, gender labor, and women's orgasm. <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8847982/>
- Piemonte, J. L. et al. (2019). Orgasm, gender, and responses to heterosexual casual sex. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0191886919304106>
- Harris, E. A. et al. (2022). Gender inequities in household labor predict lower sexual desire. <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC9483460/>
- Gottman Institute research overview. <https://www.gottman.com/about/research/>
- Gottman Institute, turning toward bids. <https://www.gottman.com/blog/turn-toward-instead-of-away/>

App Integration Notes

The guidebook suggests these coach categories:

- Dating strategy / selection: stated vs revealed preference, women as intentional selectors, men as fishermen/builders of opportunity.
- Contribution / reciprocity: useful participation, avoiding one-way consumption, asking for dignified contribution.
- Sex / pacing: no-strings-attached risks, casual-sex asymmetry, sex as access not proof of commitment.
- Social rivalry / reputation: female peer pressure, gossip, envy, shame, intrasexual dynamics.
- Information diet / contempt risk: modern feminist and red-pill scripts as behavioral inputs.
- Public respect / dignity: public correction, humiliation, couple status.
- Digital boundary / loyalty: DMs, secrecy, attention leakage.
- Behavior change: durable routines, not endless processing.
- Repair / rupture: what happened, what it meant, what changes next time.
- Life reset / grounding: when romance becomes the only scoreboard for meaning.

The next app improvement should be to let the coach cite which chapter/card informed an answer, so the user can see whether advice came from Orion-style incentives, Kait-style revealed preference, Alison-style translation/appreciation, Vaillancourt/Dani social-rivalry research, Louise Perry sexual-market critique, or relationship-science repair data.